CaseNote Lab

OET Writing workbook for nurses

Free sample case · full pack (24 cases + app) at kitwisestudio.github.io/casenote-lab

How to use this workbook: read the case notes for 5 minutes without writing, then write your letter in 40 minutes on the lined page (body about 180–200 words). Afterwards, type it into the CaseNote Lab app to check which key notes you used, then compare with the model letter at the back.

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T09 · Child after appendicectomy – wound review

Paediatric surgical ward · Discharge · easy · Today's date: 12 January 2026

Writing task. Using the information in the case notes, write a letter to Ms Fiona Grant, Practice Nurse at Leo's GP surgery, who will review his wound and remove his sutures. Address the letter to Ms Fiona Grant, Practice Nurse, Hawthorn Medical Practice, 22 Mill Lane, Kettering NN15 6TQ. In your answer: expand the relevant notes into complete sentences; do not use note form; use letter format. The body of the letter should be approximately 180–200 words.

PATIENT DETAILS

- Leo Dawson, DOB 03/05/2017 (8 y), wt 26 kg
- Lives with parents & sister (3 y). Mother works from home – main carer during recovery
- Yr 4 pupil, Brookfield Primary School
- Plays football for local club (Saturdays)
- Family dog (Labrador) at home
- Father works night shifts – taxi driver

MEDICAL HISTORY

- Mild asthma – salbutamol 100 mcg inh PRN (rarely used). Has tolerated ibuprofen previously
- NKDA
- Immunisations up to date
- Tonsillitis x2 (2023) – treated by GP

ADMISSION

- 08/01/26: 24 h central abdo pain → RIF, vomiting x3, T 38.2°C
- Bloods: WCC 16.2, CRP 87
- USS abdo: appearances c/w acute appendicitis
- 09/01/26: laparoscopic appendicectomy under GA – appendix gangrenous, not perforated

NURSING MANAGEMENT

- IV co-amoxiclav x 48 h → oral 11/01
- Analgesia: regular paracetamol + ibuprofen – pain score 1–2/10
- Apyrexial since 10/01; obs within normal limits
- Anxious re needles (cannula) – play specialist & distraction helpful
- Wounds: 2 lateral port sites closed with tissue glue – healing well
- Umbilical port: non-absorbable sutures; mild erythema, no discharge
- Wound swab (umbilicus) sent 11/01 – result pending

DISCHARGE PLAN

- Co-amoxiclav 250/62 mg/5 mL susp, 5 mL TDS – 5 more days (complete 16/01)
- Practice nurse: wound review + removal of umbilical sutures day 10 post-op (19/01/26)
- Parents taught signs of wound infection; to contact GP/ward if concerned
- Off school 1/52; no PE/contact sport x 4/52
- No surgical OPD f/u needed; histology → GP

Your letter

Your letter

Model letters

Try each task yourself before reading its model letter.

T09 · Child after appendicectomy – wound review

Ms Fiona Grant
Practice Nurse
Hawthorn Medical Practice
22 Mill Lane
Kettering NN15 6TQ

12 January 2026

Dear Ms Grant,

Re: Leo Dawson, DOB 03/05/2017

I am writing to request that you review the umbilical wound of Leo Dawson, an eight-year-old boy who is being discharged home today, and remove his sutures on 19 January.

Leo was admitted on 8 January with acute appendicitis and underwent a laparoscopic appendicectomy the following day. The appendix was found to be gangrenous but had not perforated. He received intravenous antibiotics for 48 hours and is now taking oral co-amoxiclav 250/62 mg suspension, 5 mL three times daily, for a further five days. His pain is well controlled with regular paracetamol and ibuprofen, which may be given as required after 48 hours. Although he has mild asthma, he has tolerated ibuprofen without any problems.

Two port sites closed with tissue glue are healing well. However, the umbilical wound, which has non-absorbable sutures, shows mild erythema without discharge. A wound swab was taken yesterday and the result is pending.

His parents have been taught to recognise the signs of wound infection. Leo should stay off school for one week and avoid contact sports and physical education for four weeks.

Please do not hesitate to contact me if you have any queries.

Yours sincerely,

Staff Nurse
Ward 12 (Paediatric Surgery), Northfield General Hospital

WHY IT IS WRITTEN THIS WAY

- The opening sentence tells the practice nurse exactly what is needed (wound review and suture removal) and when.
- The presenting symptoms, admission blood results and needle anxiety are left out: they are history, and the practice nurse does not need them to check a wound.
- Asthma is a tricky note: it is only worth mentioning because it shows that ibuprofen is safe for Leo.
- The wound details are grouped together and the problem wound (umbilical erythema, swab pending) comes after the ones that are healing well, introduced with 'However'.
- Useful phrases: 'underwent a laparoscopic appendicectomy', 'may be given as required', 'the result is pending'.